



This malware hits 1/10 Macs

Kaspersky noted that a malware dubbed the Shlayer Trojan hits 10 percent of all Macs Kaspersky monitors. <https://digit.in/feb20-39>



Vine is back as Byte

Byte is a new version of the famous video app, Vine, and is now available on both iOS and Android. <https://digit.in/feb20-40>



have ever seen and you'll never run out of material to practice. Some categories have more challenges than others, but each has enough (for example, App-Sys-tem category has a 73 challenges!).

There are a total of 11 categories, with the standard cybersecurity topics like steganography, cryptanalysis, etc. An interesting "Network" category also exists which deals specifically with analysis of captured network traffic including different protocols. Solving challenges here will be a great way to strengthen your grip on protocols which plays an essential part when you actually encounter the network entrails while reviewing a web application or pentesting an online system. Challenge creators include admins and users, but mostly admins. A ranking system is also present, where you can rank-up from newbie to a lamer, on to programmer, hacker then finally elite.

Labs on Root-me are in a section called "CTF", where there 40 rooms available. You can choose any empty room, select a vulnerable environment and complete the requirements. Any player can join the room, and the competition (of sorts) ends when someone enters the final flag or when the timer run-outs, whichever is first. We noticed that most of environments were virtual machines from VulnHub, so this is basically like an online version of selected VulnHub machines.

As far as the community goes, a forum is present. As mentioned above, Root-me, being a challenges focussed platform, cover the major portion of the forum with a separate topic for each category where problems belonging to that categories are discussed. Just like HackThisSite, Root-me has its own IRC channel and they are pretty active there. There's a chatbox present in the sidebar

of the website which can be used to communicate with other members.

HONORABLE MENTIONS:

Here some platforms didn't not quite made our list but are still pretty helpful. So, you can check them out if you want some more options.

1. The Web Security Academy

[\[https://portswigger.net/web-security\]](https://portswigger.net/web-security)

"The Web Application Hacker's Handbook(WAHH)" is considered a holy-grail when it comes to web application pentesting. In the olden days, the website used to have solutions to the problems present in the book and related labs, for which you needed to on hourly basis. But recently Dafydd Stuttard (known as "portswigger" and the creator of BurpSuite) who authored the book, presented Web Security Academy as the successor to WAHH where all labs are free of

cost, covering all the topics of web security. Solutions are also present, in case you get stuck. Make sure to check it out.

2. OverTheWire: Wargames

[\[https://overthewire.org/wargames/\]](https://overthewire.org/wargames/)

The aim of this website is to teach Linux and security concepts through games which will keep you engaged and they are quite fun as well. Different levels are present and a recommended order to go through the levels is present on their website. The easiest and most popular level, Bandit, teaches Linux and networking concepts in a pretty interesting manner. Each level can be accessed through a Secure Shell (SSH) connection and URLs are present in descriptions. To proceed to the next level, you will need to solve the previous since it will contain the password needed for the next level.

3. HACK.ME

[\[https://hack.me/\]](https://hack.me/)

A sandbox which provides mainly vulnerable web applications, which you can access on the fly without any configurations. The activeness of the community seemed pretty low to us as the last revision done a sandbox was on 10th April 2019. Still, there's no harm in exploring and having fun with the machines because you never know what you might learn.

ADDITIONAL GUIDELINES:

Even though security is hard to get into, it's not impossible. Security community, be it on Twitter or Discord or Slack or anywhere, is one most supportive ones we have seen. Here is some technical and social advice we wish someone had given us when we first started out:

Get into habit of making notes. Each step you do, each hack you perform, each exploit you create, make sure it's well documented.

Before approaching someone with your questions, do your homework and research. While most of the people will surely help you, some are busy or get too many such questions that they might lash out on you which might demoralise you, so make sure to try as much as you can on your own.

While choosing a pentesting toolset you can either choose Kali Linux [\[https://www.kali.org/downloads/\]](https://www.kali.org/downloads/) or ParrotOS [\[https://parrotlinux.org/\]](https://parrotlinux.org/). You can also select a distro of your own liking and add the required tools. Windows is not at all recommended.

Don't share spoilers. If you are helping someone, guide them to the right approach instead of just giving them the answers. Learning is most effective when done on your own.

CONCLUSION:

Spending enough time on any of the platforms mentioned above and grinding with persistence is sure to enhance your skills to a point that you can start considering cybersecurity as a career option rather than just an interesting hobby. It's time to step up your security game. Happy Hacking! 🚩

